

Pedestrian Protection Hybrid Automaton Formalization

The hybrid automaton formalized here captures the decision logic governing pedestrian-related interventions. Its structure reflects a separation between discrete modes, encoding the high-level behavioral states of the controller, and a continuous component responsible for maintaining timing information and buffering perception-related quantities. The following sections collect all formal ingredients used by the automaton, including the thresholds that parameterize the guards and invariants, the predicates over buffered observations, and the reset and sensing functions.

TABLE I
AUTOMATON THRESHOLDS

name	semantic	value
n	number of buffered detections	10
D_FREQ	detection frequency (ms)	100
RT_H	human reaction time (ms)	700
TH_C	threshold for valid detection	0.4
D_STALE	upper bound for stale detections (ms)	300
C_STALE	upper bound for stale crossing (ms)	300
TH_TTC_s	threshold for safe TTC (ms)	3500
TH_TTC_r	threshold for risky TTC (ms)	2000
TH_TTC_c	threshold for critical TTC (ms)	1000
S_CONS	% for for safe TTC classification	0.8
SR_CONS	% for safe-risky TTC classification	0.6
RC_CONS	% for risky-critical TTC classification	0.4
C_CONS	% for critical TTC classification	0.2
CONS	% of agreeing frames	0.8

The numerical parameters in Table I regulate how perception evidence is aggregated and how fast stale information is discarded. They are intentionally chosen so that reaction-relevant quantities (e.g., TTC estimates) are evaluated over a short, recent observation window, allowing the controller to remain responsive while filtering short-lived outliers. Based on these parameters, we now introduce the predicates used in the invariants and guards.

Definition 1 (Discrete Modes). The finite set of discrete locations Q is defined as follows.

$$Q = \{\text{Normal}, \text{Throttle}, \text{SoftBrk}, \text{EmergencyBrk}\},$$

Definition 2 (Continuous State Variables). Let the continuous state space be $X \subseteq \mathbb{R}^{3n+3}$. Each state vector $x \in X$ is defined as

$$x = (C_0, \dots, C_{n-1}, TTC_0, \dots, TTC_{n-1}, cs_0, \dots, cs_{n-1}, s_d, s_c, t)$$

where:

- n is the number of detections the automaton considers;
- $C_i \in [0, 1]$, with $i = 0, \dots, n-1$: confidence of the pedestrian detection in the i -th frame;

- $TTC_i > 0$, with $i = 0, \dots, n-1$: estimated time-to-collision in the i -th frame;
- $cs_i \in \{0, 1\}$, with $i = 0, \dots, n-1$: pedestrian crossing indicator in the i -th frame;
- s_d, s_c : timers for detection staleness, crossing staleness, respectively;
- t : time since the last sensor update.

For readability, we omit explicit quantification over x and the use of projection functions (e.g., we write TTC_i instead of $\pi_{TTC_i}(x)$) in subsequent definitions.

Definition 3 (Continuous Dynamics). The continuous dynamics $f : Q \times X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{3n+3}$, which assigns a **vector field** for continuous evolution in each discrete state, for each $q \in Q$ is defined as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \dot{C}_i &= 0, \quad \dot{TTC}_i = 0, \quad \dot{cs}_i = 0 \quad \text{with } i = 0, \dots, n-1, \\ \dot{s}_d &= 1000, \quad \dot{s}_c = 1000, \quad \dot{t} = 1000, \end{aligned}$$

The predicates below formalize the conditions under which a sequence of buffered measurements provides sufficiently strong evidence of a detection or a crossing event. Each predicate follows the same structural pattern: it inspects the most recent entries of the buffer and checks for temporal consistency, thereby avoiding spurious mode switches due to isolated sensor noise.

Definition 4 (Detection Predicate). Given $x \in X$, the predicate detected is defined as follows.

$$\text{detected}(x) = \forall i \in [0, \frac{RT_H}{2 \cdot D_FREQ}] . C_i \geq TH_C$$

Definition 5 (Valid detection). Given $x \in X$, the predicate valid_d is defined as follows.

$$\text{valid_d}(x) = \text{detected}(x) \vee s_d < D_STALE$$

Definition 6 (Crossing predicate). Given $x \in X$, the predicate crossing is defined as follows.

$$\text{crossing}(x) = \forall i \in [0, \frac{RT_H}{2 \cdot D_FREQ}] . cs_i = 1$$

Definition 7 (Valid crossing). Given $x \in X$, the predicate valid_c is defined as follows.

$$\text{valid_c}(x) = \text{crossing}(x) \vee s_c < C_STALE$$

Threat classification relies on estimating TTC over the buffered frames. To mitigate the influence of occasional misestimates, each TTC-level predicate uses a consensus requirement over a prefix of the buffer, scaled according to the severity of the corresponding threat class. Lower TTC thresholds naturally require fewer agreeing observations, reflecting the need to react quickly as risk increases.

Definition 8 (Safe distance predicate). Given $x \in X$, the predicate s_TTC is defined as follows.

$$s_TTC(x) = \sum_{i=0}^k P_i \geq \lceil k \cdot \text{CONS} \rceil$$

where $P_i = 1$ if $TTC_i > \text{TH_TTC_s}$, otherwise $P_i = 0$ and $k = \lceil n \cdot \text{S_CONS} \rceil$.

Definition 9 (Safe-Risky TTC predicate). Given $x \in X$, the predicate sr_TTC is defined as follows.

$$sr_TTC(x) = \sum_{i=0}^k P_i \geq \lceil k \cdot \text{CONS} \rceil$$

where $P_i = 1$ if $TTC_i \leq \text{TH_TTC_s}$, otherwise $P_i = 0$ and $k = \lceil n \cdot \text{SR_CONS} \rceil$.

Definition 10 (Risky-Critical TTC predicate). Given $x \in X$, the predicate rc_TTC is defined as follows.

$$rc_TTC(x) = \sum_{i=0}^k P_i \geq \lceil k \cdot \text{CONS} \rceil$$

where $P_i = 1$ if $TTC_i \leq \text{TH_TTC_r}$, otherwise $P_i = 0$ and $k = \lceil n \cdot \text{RC_CONS} \rceil$.

Definition 11 (Critical TTC predicate). Given $x \in X$, the predicate c_TTC is defined as follows.

$$c_TTC(x) = \sum_{i=0}^k P_i \geq \lceil k \cdot \text{CONS} \rceil$$

where $P_i = 1$ if $TTC_i \leq \text{TH_TTC_c}$, otherwise $P_i = 0$ and $k = \lceil n \cdot \text{C_CONS} \rceil$.

Definition 12 (No TTC consensus). Given $x \in X$, the predicate $uncertain$ as defined as follows.

$$\text{uncertain}(x) = \neg s_TTC(x) \wedge \neg sr_TTC(x) \wedge \neg rc_TTC(x) \wedge \neg c_TTC(x)$$

The mode-dependent invariants express admissible continuous states while the automaton resides in a given discrete location. These invariants enforce that the controller remains in a state only as long as the corresponding perception conditions remain compatible with that mode. In particular, they ensure that stale information cannot lock the automaton in a mode indefinitely, and that a new sensor update (captured by the timer t) eventually forces a transition through the sensing edge.

Definition 13 (State Invariants). The function $\text{Inv} : Q \rightarrow 2^X$ is defined as follows.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Inv}(\text{Normal}) &= \{x \in X \mid (\neg \text{valid_d}(x) \vee \neg \text{valid_c}(x) \vee s_TTC(x) \vee \text{uncertain}(x)) \wedge t < \text{D_FREQ}\} \\ \text{Inv}(\text{Throttle}) &= \{x \in X \mid \text{valid_c}(x) \wedge ((sr_TTC(x) \wedge \neg rc_TTC(x) \wedge \neg c_TTC(x)) \vee \text{uncertain}(x)) \wedge t < \text{D_FREQ}\} \\ \text{Inv}(\text{SoftBrk}) &= \{x \in X \mid \text{valid_c}(x) \wedge ((rc_TTC(x) \wedge \neg c_TTC(x)) \vee \text{uncertain}(x)) \wedge t < \text{D_FREQ}\} \\ \text{Inv}(\text{EmergencyBrk}) &= \{x \in X \mid \text{valid_c}(x) \wedge t < \text{D_FREQ}\} \end{aligned}$$

The transition structure is fully enumerated by the edges in Definition 14. Each edge corresponds to a possible qualitative change in the controller's behaviour, ranging from maintaining the current mode to escalating the intervention level. The resulting graph is acyclic except for the intentional self-loops, which allow the automaton to accommodate new measurements without generating unnecessary mode changes.

Definition 14 (Edges). The set of edges $E \subseteq Q \times Q$ is $\{e_1, \dots, e_{22}\}$, where

$$\begin{aligned} e_1 &= (\text{Normal}, \text{Normal}) \\ e_2 &= (\text{Normal}, \text{Throttle}) \\ e_3 &= (\text{Normal}, \text{SoftBrk}) \\ e_4 &= (\text{Normal}, \text{EmergencyBrk}) \\ e_5 &= (\text{Throttle}, \text{Normal}) \\ e_6 &= (\text{Throttle}, \text{Throttle}) \\ e_7 &= (\text{Throttle}, \text{SoftBrk}) \\ e_8 &= (\text{Throttle}, \text{EmergencyBrk}) \\ e_9 &= (\text{SoftBrk}, \text{Normal}) \\ e_{10} &= (\text{SoftBrk}, \text{Throttle}) \\ e_{11} &= (\text{SoftBrk}, \text{SoftBrk}) \\ e_{12} &= (\text{SoftBrk}, \text{EmergencyBrk}) \\ e_{13} &= (\text{EmergencyBrk}, \text{Normal}) \\ e_{14} &= (\text{EmergencyBrk}, \text{EmergencyBrk}) \end{aligned}$$

Guard conditions determine precisely when a discrete transition may fire. They combine substantive perception predicates with a timing constraint on t , ensuring that transitions triggered by new sensor readings are prioritised over those triggered by stale information. Structurally, the guards partition all admissible states in such a way that the automaton remains deterministic whenever a transition is enabled.

Definition 15 (Guards). Guard conditions $G : E \rightarrow 2^X$, for each edge, are defined as follows.

$$\begin{aligned} G(e_1) &= \{x \in X \mid t \geq \text{D_FREQ}\} \\ G(e_2) &= \{x \in X \mid \text{valid_c}(x) \wedge sr_TTC(x) \wedge \neg rc_TTC(x) \wedge \neg c_TTC(x) \wedge t < \text{D_FREQ}\} \\ G(e_3) &= \{x \in X \mid \text{valid_c}(x) \wedge rc_TTC(x) \wedge \neg c_TTC(x) \wedge t < \text{D_FREQ}\} \\ G(e_4) &= \{x \in X \mid \text{valid_c}(x) \wedge c_TTC(x) \wedge t < \text{D_FREQ}\} \\ G(e_5) &= \{x \in X \mid (\neg \text{valid_d}(x) \vee (\text{valid_c}(x) \wedge s_TTC(x))) \wedge t < \text{D_FREQ}\} \\ G(e_6) &= G(e_1) \\ G(e_7) &= G(e_3) \\ G(e_8) &= G(e_4) \\ G(e_9) &= G(e_5) \\ G(e_{10}) &= G(e_2) \\ G(e_{11}) &= G(e_1) \\ G(e_{12}) &= G(e_5) \\ G(e_{13}) &= \{x \in X \mid \neg \text{valid_c}(x)\} \end{aligned}$$

$$G(e_{14}) = G(e_1)$$

The functions *sense* and *reset* govern how the continuous state is updated upon taking an edge. The former incorporates a fresh sensor measurement and shifts the history buffers, while the latter keeps the existing measurements but selectively resets the staleness counters. Together, they ensure that the automaton cleanly separates the arrival of new data from pure time-driven maintenance steps.

Definition 16 (Sense function). Given $x \in X$, the sense function $\text{sense} : X \rightarrow 2^X$ is defined as follows.

$$\text{sense}(x) = \{x' \in X \mid \phi(x, x')\}$$

where,

$$x = (C_0, \dots, C_{n-1}, TTC_0, \dots, TTC_{n-1}, \\ cs_0, \dots, cs_{n-1}, s_d, s_c, t)$$

and

$$x' = (C, C_0, \dots, C_{n-2}, TTC, TTC_0, \dots, TTC_{n-2}, \\ cs, cs_0, \dots, cs_{n-2}, s_d, s_c, t'),$$

the predicate $\phi(x, x')$ holds if $t' = 0$, $C \in [0, 1]$

$$TTC = \begin{cases} \text{NO_TTC} & \text{if } C < \text{TH_C}, \\ v \in \mathbb{R}_{>0} & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases}$$

$$cs = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } C < \text{TH_C}, \\ v \in \{0, 1\} & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases}$$

Definition 17 (Reset timers function). Given $x \in X$, the reset timers function $\text{reset} : X \rightarrow 2^X$ is defined as follows.

$$\text{reset}(x) = \{x' \in X \mid \phi(x, x')\}$$

where

$$x = (C_0, \dots, C_{n-1}, TTC_0, \dots, TTC_{n-1}, \\ cs_0, \dots, cs_{n-1}, s_d, s_c, t)$$

and

$$x' = (C_0, \dots, C_{n-1}, TTC_0, \dots, TTC_{n-1}, \\ cs_0, \dots, cs_{n-1}, s'_d, s'_c, t)$$

the predicate $\phi(x, x')$ holds if

$$s'_d = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if detected}(x) \\ s_d & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$s'_c = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if crossing}(x) \\ s_c & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Definition 18 (Reset). Given $x \in X$, the function $R : E \times X \rightarrow 2^X$, for each $e \in E$, is defined as follows.

$$R(e, x) = \begin{cases} \text{sense}(x) & \text{if } t \geq \text{D_FREQ} \\ \text{reset}(x) & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Combining the discrete locations, continuous dynamics, invariants, guards, and reset maps yields a fully specified hybrid automaton that captures the entire control logic of the pedestrian-protection system. This formalisation is suitable both for implementation-level reference and for verification tasks such as reachability analysis or mode-transition correctness proofs.